Moral Agency – Study 5 (#90531)

Authors
This pre-registration is currently anonymous to enable blind peer-review.
It has 3 authors.

Pre-registered on:
2022/03/10 09:57 (PT)

1) Have any data been collected for this study already?
No, no data have been collected for this study yet.

2) What's the main question being asked or hypothesis being tested in this study?
Are employees who are given moral agency more likely to sabotage disrespectful customers? And if so, are variables like retaliatory justice or an obligation to the employer responsible for this phenomenon?

Hypothesis 1 (comparisons between conditions):
• People in the agency condition
o Will be more likely to sabotage
o Will be less likely to de-escalate
o Will be more likely to agree that the reason for their behavior is because the customer deserved it
• People in the compliance condition
o Will be more likely to de-escalate
o Will be less like to sabotage
o Will be more likely to agree that the reason for their behavior is because of an obligation to employer

Hypothesis 2 (mediations between IV and DV):
• There are two main variables that will mediate the relationship between agency/compliance and sabotage/de-escalation:
o How much a participant agrees that the reason for their behavior is because the customer deserved it (aka "retaliatory justice")
o How much a participant agrees that the reason for their behavior is because of an obligation to employer

3) Describe the key dependent variable(s) specifying how they will be measured.
Our key dependent variables will be how likely the participants are to endorse either sabotaging behaviors or de-escalating behaviors. We will provide the same list of behaviors and ask questions in each condition relating to the extent to which participants would actually do them. The behaviors will be measured on a 5-point Likert scale (Not at all likely (1) – Extremely likely (5)). The mediator variables will be those listed under Hypothesis 2, and they will be measured through two questions on a 7-point Likert scale (Strongly disagree (1) – Strongly Agree (7)).

4) How many and which conditions will participants be assigned to?
Participants will be assigned to one of two between-subjects priming conditions (agency vs. compliance).

5) Specify exactly which analyses you will conduct to examine the main question/hypothesis.
Hypothesis 1 will be examined through independent samples t-tests. Hypothesis 2 will be examined through mediational analyses. The mediation models will consist of one mediator variable at a time, not multiple mediators in a single model.

6) Describe exactly how outliers will be defined and handled, and your precise rule(s) for excluding observations.
We will exclude participants who fail the attention check embedded in the procedure, or the final item of the survey asking about attention. Failure of the attention check will entail any responses other than the single response indicating the participant paid attention.

7) How many observations will be collected or what will determine sample size? No need to justify decision, but be precise about exactly how the number will be determined.
We aim for 340 participants to allow for exclusions due to inattention (failure of attention checks) or failing to complete the study.

8) Anything else you would like to pre-register? (e.g., secondary analyses, variables collected for exploratory purposes, unusual analyses planned?)
This is a replication study using a different sample that will consist of white-collar workers (people who work in an office role). We will also be assessing this sample on what industry they work in, how long they've been working in their current job, how often they talk to customers directly, and how much customer service experience they have. This sample will also be assessed on how much they feel an obligation to their current employer. This variable will be used in exploratory analyses.